SHARKATHON

Be the Next Big Shark

Sample questions (The CEO Round)

A plant produces both t-shirts and shirts. Of the total clothes produced last year, 1/3 were T Shirts, the balance being Shirts. The total salary bill for the factory was Rs 18 lakhs. If one shirt takes 50% more time compared to a T-shirt to produce, and if the factory salary has to be divided between T-shirts and Shirts based on the total time spent producing each kind of clothing, then the amount of salary to be allocated to T-Shirts will be:

A . Rs 4.5 lakhs
B. Rs 6.67 lakhs
C. Rs 9.0 lakhs
D. Rs 12.0 lakhs
E. Cannot be determined from the information provided

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Sample questions (The CEO Round)

Answer: A

Logic: If the time taken for a single T Shirt is x minutes, then the time taken per shirt is 1.5x minutes.
Since 1/3rd of clothes are Tshirts, 2/3rds would be shirts, so ratio of T Shirts to Shirts is 1:2.

Total time spent: Time for Tshirts + Time for Shirts = (x minutes per Tshirt * 1 part Tshirts + 1.5x minutes per shirt * 2 part shirts)
Ratio of time spent: (T Shirts / Total of TShirts + Shirts) = (x*1)/ ((x*1)+(1.5x*2)) = x/ (x+3x) = x/4x = 1/4
Hence, cost of T Shirts to be 1/4th the total cost = Rs 4.5 lakhs

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Sample questions (The CEO Round)

A famous Technology economics magazine in India, widely available across book stores and airports across India, did two surveys. The findings were:

- Findings from subscribers survey: Thirty per cent of all orders placed by subscribers in response to ads placed in the magazine last year were placed by subscribers under the age of thirty-five.
- Findings from advertiser surveys: Most of the orders placed in response to advertisements in the magazine last year were placed by people under the age of thirty-five.

For both of the findings to be accurate, which of the following must be true?

- More subscribers who have never ordered in response to advertisements in the magazine are aged thirty-five or over.
- Among the subscribers, the proportion who are under the age of thirty-five was considerably lower last year than 2 years ago.
- Most orders placed in response to advertisements in the magazine last year were placed by subscribers over the age of thirty-five.
- Last year, the average revenue per order placed was less for subscribers under age thirty-five than for those aged thirty-five or over.
- Last year, many people who placed orders, in response to advertisements in the magazine were not subscribers to the magazine.

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Sample questions (The CEO Round)

Answer: 5 Logic: While the subscriber survey suggests only 30% of orders are from <35 year old consumers, the advertiser survey put this number at >50%. Now, the only way this can be possible is that it is not only subscribers, but also people who buy the magazine from bookstores or general shops, who see the advertisement and place an order for advertised goods, and somehow these orders are mostly placed by people below 35 years old, skewing the average of total orders placed such that people below 35 years old have a majority of orders. The other options do not have relevance to the core question at all.

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Sample questions (The CEO Round)

The management of a famous restaurant in North East Delhi gave the following information to its CEO: “Our revenues in North East Delhi declined by 10,000 consumers during the year. This is likely entirely due to the launch of a food delivery service in the area that, in addition to delivering both tasty and cheap food made by its cooks in central locations (cloud kitchens) targeting the student population living in the area, also delivered food from neighbourhood restaurants to people’s homes for a fee. We should tie up with it.” The CEO was not convinced. He said “I know from some reliable sources that the cloud kitchens of the food delivery company prepared dishes for only 4,000 orders. Yet our fall was 10,000 consumers. There are other bigger reasons why our sales have declined. We should not do a tie-up.”

Which of the following, if true, would most seriously weaken the CEO’s argument:

A. Three restaurants shut down in North East Delhi during the year

B. During the year, the food delivery company did more deliveries for neighbourhood restaurants than its cloud kitchen orders

C. 70% of restaurants in the area offer discounts of 25% during non-peak hours on food orders

D. People generally order 3 dishes per order in a restaurant and 2.5 dishes while ordering for home delivery

E. For 2 months, there was road construction work happening just outside the entrance to the restaurant, making entry more difficult.

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Sample questions (The CEO Round)

Answer: B Logic: We have to look for points that WEAKEN the CEOs argument. In other words, we have to look for arguments that support that the food delivery service is negatively impacting the business. The CEO knows that the delivery service has produced a far lesser number of dishes than the fall in demand seen by the restaurant. However, if this service also collects orders from other restaurants and delivers them, then the dishes made by the food delivery service itself is immaterial, since the fall in demand could be happening because people order from home, but simply order from other competing restaurants present on the delivery service.

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Sample questions (The CEO Round)

During the harvest season, grain is being brought into an empty warehouse constantly every day through trucks. At the same time, it releases a certain constant quantity of grain every day to milling factories across the region for making flour. Unless grain is stored in the warehouse, it will get spoiled in the next rain. 400 metric tonnes of grain are waiting for storage in the warehouse. How long will it take for the warehouse to get filled? Two statements are provided:

I. The total capacity of grain the empty warehouse can hold is 120 metric tonnes
II. The trucks bringing grains can completely fill the empty warehouse in 10 days if there are no outward deliveries to milling factories. The trucks carrying grain for milling can completely empty a filled warehouse in 15 days if there are no fresh inward supplies of grains. The trucks do not interfere with one another.

A. Statement I alone is sufficient but statement II alone is not sufficient to answer the question asked.
B. Statement II alone is sufficient but statement I alone is not sufficient to answer the question asked.
C. Both statements I and II together are sufficient to answer the question but neither statement is sufficient alone.
D. Each statement alone is sufficient to answer the question.
E. Statements I and II are not sufficient to answer the question asked and additional data is needed to answer the statements.

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Sample questions (The CEO Round)

Answer: B Logic: Statement I tells us nothing about how long it will take for the capacity to get filled, or emptied. Statement II suggests that 1/10th of the warehouse can get filled in a day, and 1/15th of the warehouse can get emptied in a day. Solving for these, it appears that (15-10)/150 of the warehouse, ie 1/30th of the warehouse gets filled every day. This statement therefore is enough to tell us that the entire warehouse can be filled in 30 days.

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Sample questions (The Consultant Round)

MedTech is a mid-sized manufacturer of specialized diagnostic equipment for hospitals across India. The company has maintained stable revenue but faces pressure to improve profitability in the coming year. The management has collected sales data from various competitors, as well as for itself for the year gone by.

MedTech: Price per unit Rs 190 and quantity sold are 120 Alphacare: Price per unit Rs 200 and quantity sold are 110 Arogya Instruments: Price per unit Rs 210 and quantity sold are 100 Indus Health: Price per unit Rs 240 and quantity sold are 80 In addition, the company knows that the Variable Cost per unit is 160 and Fixed Costs will 2,000 for each competitor, as well as for itself. MedTech has an option to follow the pricing strategy of any of its competitors, and the quantity sold will then be the same as the quantity that the competitor whose price is being copied sells. What should MedTech do next year?

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Sample questions (The Consultant Round)

Answer: The student could do something like this and respond that replicating the Indus pricing strategy will be better from a profitability perspective.

If asked, additional considerations could include importance of market share, brand impact, etc.

Particulars	Replicate Alphacare pricing	Replicate Arogya pricing	Replicate Indus pricing
Revenue minus variable cost per unit	200-160=40	210-160=50	240-160=80
Contribution (profit / unit * units)	40*110=4400	50*100=5000	80*80 = 6400
Profit after Fixed costs	4400-2000=2200	5000-2000=3000	***6400-2000=4400***

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Sample Situation (The Investor Round)

OatMighty, founded in 2023 by Shruti Gupta (IIT Delhi and IIM Ahmedabad alumnus, is India's first flavour-led, high-protein oats brand for individuals who want a healthy yet delicious breakfast. The ready-to-mix range delivers a protein-packed meal that is not bland or boring, and can taste closer to dessert than diet food. Operating for just over two years, OatMighty sells business-to-consumer in the food and cereals category, with only a few similar-stage rivals. Its moat is clear: better taste and flavour innovation, backed by strong nutritional content. The obtainable market is estimated at 500 crore over the next few years, with headroom for a scaled national brand.

Particulars	Year 1 (Rs)	Year 2 (Rs)
Items	10,000	20,000
Value per item	1,000	1,000
Total revenue	10,000,000	20,000,000
Total Cost of Goods Sold	7,500,000	15,000,000
Gross profits	2,500,000	5,000,000
Less: Research and Development	1,000,000	
Less: Salaries	300,000	300,000
Less: Marketing	2,000,000	5,500,000
Less: Rent	300,000	300,000
EBITDA	-1,100,000	-1,100,000
Interest cost	0	0
PBT (Profit Before Tax)	-1,100,000	-1,100,000
PBT % / Revenues	-11.00%	-5.50%

Ask: INR 5 cr for 20% stake

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Contact Us

Phone

+91 9953371191

Email

team@veriseekeducation.com

Website

www.veriseekeducation.com/sharkathon

Location

AltF MPD Tower, 2nd Floor, Golf Course Road, Sector 43, Gurugram, Haryana 122002

To apply scan